

Also add what happens if it's not received in time- will the deadline be extended and recalculated and how far does it get pushed.

On the flip side, you may also need to mention what will happen if the deadline is not met. Be careful with this point and pin down mutually agreeable terms with your client. Ensure that you stick to the agreed upon timeline so you can be assured of encountering no difficulties in raising the invoice.

Advance and payment terms

Don't hesitate to ask for an advance. You will be surprised to see how amenable clients are to pay an advance. The extent of the advance amount can vary from client to client or project to project. Talk to the client about your expectations and come to an agreeable figure. Also, specify that any deadlines will start or work will commence only after the advance is received.

You may also have staggered payments just like staggered deadlines. They may be linked to milestones or specific timeframes like weekly, fortnightly or monthly payments. Specify that you will raise an invoice at every step and what is the time in which the payment is to be made. You can agree upon part payment before delivery and balance later or complete payment upon delivery or a credit period of 7 days, 15 days etc. Discuss this with the client and agree upon a system that you are comfortable



Ensure that you keep the door open on the possibility of legal recourse
in a worst case scenario